

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major sit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 5♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦4

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠7

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥2

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 5♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥3

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 5 2
 ♥ 10 4
 ♦ A 9 8 5
 ♣ 8 6 4

♠ 3

♥ K J 9 6 5 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K Q 5



♠ A 10 7 6 4

♥ Q

♦ 10 7 4 3

♣ 10 7 3

♠ K Q J

♥ A 8 7 3

♦ 6 2

♣ A J 9 2

NORTH bids 3♠ to show a strong hand with a singleton ♠.

After SOUTH shows her first-round ♣ control NORTH decides he will bid slam if SOUTH has three Aces.

When Blackwood reveals just two Aces in SOUTH, NORTH stops at 5♥.

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by North			
Lead: ♦4			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9
♥ Q J 8 3
♦ Q J 9 6
♣ J 2

♠ K 10 5 4 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A 10 5

♣ A 9 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6

♥ A K 9 7 2

♦ 8 7

♣ K Q 8 6 5

♠ J 8 7 3

♥ 10 4

♦ K 4 3 2

♣ 10 4 3

EAST bids 4♣ after WEST's Jacoby 2NT. The reason for this bid is just to describe her hand as having a side 5-card ♣ suit. EAST knows the eventual contract will be some level of ♥s.

WEST doesn't have a strong hand, but he would show ♦ control at this time if he had the Ace. He isn't strong enough to go past game to show the ♠ A, so he just bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♠7

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10
♥ 4 3 2
♦ Q 10 3
♣ K 10 9 8 3 2

♠ Q J 8 4

♥ K 8 7 5

♦ A J 4

♣ 6 4



♠ 3 2

♥ A Q 10 6

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 7 5

♠ A K 9 7 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ K 7 5

♣ A Q

NORTH should not be tempted to use Jacoby 2NT with this hand. There are only 12 points, and the Limit Raise is a perfect way to show a 12 point support hand.

SOUTH has more than enough strength to bid game after NORTH's limit raise. If NORTH had mistakenly used a Jacoby 2NT response, SOUTH would probably have tried to reach slam, and perhaps gotten too high.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 2			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 9 5 4

♥ A Q 8

♦ Q 9 7

♣ Q J

♠ A 2

♥ 10 4 3 2

♦ 5 4 2

♣ 10 9 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6 3

♥ K J 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 5

♠ 7

♥ 9 6 5

♦ J 10 8 6

♣ A 8 7 6 4

WEST bids 3NT to show a good hand with five ♠s.

EAST shows his ♦ control, and WEST then shows her ♥ control.

A final check with Blackwood shows two Aces missing. Too bad.

West

1 ♠

3NT

4 ♥

5 ♦

All Pass

5 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥3

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

4 ♦

4NT

5 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

Pass

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ J 7
♦ 10 8 5 3
♣ J 7 6 4 2

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ A 3

♦ J 6 2

♣ K Q



♠ 3
♥ 10 6 5 4 2
♦ A K 7
♣ 10 9 8 3

♠ K J 9 6

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ Q 9 4

♣ A 5

NORTH shows his 6-card ♠ suit by bidding 3♠.

SOUTH shows her ♣ control and NORTH shows his ♥ control, but it seems neither has a control in ♦s.

So they stop in game.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♦K			